

Arte Merritt

Agentic AI & Conversational AI Leader · Two-Time Founder · Keynote Speaker
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Two-time venture-backed founder (one exit to Nokia), 15+ years inside conversational and agentic AI. Current operating role at **Microsoft** after **AWS**. Career arc: early mobile analytics → chatbot & voice-AI wave → present **agentic-AI shift**. Frequent international keynote speaker. Author of *The Agentic Shift* (2026). Active angel; building **Reconify**, observability for LLM applications.

EXPERIENCE

Agentic AI & Strategic Partnerships · Microsoft

Microsoft AI / Azure AI

April 2026 — Present · SF Bay Area

- Building Microsoft's **agentic-AI partner ecosystem** — Copilot Studio, Azure AI Foundry, Azure OpenAI, AI Agents — across ISVs and enterprise integrators.
- Strategy & GTM for **autonomous AI agents** on Microsoft's distribution: Microsoft 365, Teams, Copilot, Azure marketplace.
- Working surface: agent observability, multi-agent orchestration, tool use, function calling, MCP, enterprise deployment of LLM-powered employees.

Head of Generative AI & Conversational AI Partners · Amazon Web Services (AWS)

AWS Marketplace · Generative AI Partners

2022 — 2025 · San Francisco

- Led **generative AI + conversational AI** partner strategy across AWS Marketplace — ISVs shipping **LLM applications** on **Amazon Bedrock**, **SageMaker**, and the AWS AI stack.
- Created and ran **Built on Bedrock** demo nights at the AWS Builder Loft — SF showcase for genAI builders working with Claude, Titan, Llama, Mistral on Bedrock.
- Owned partner relationships with leading agentic / conversational ISVs; built co-sell motions driving multi-million-dollar AI deals through AWS field sales.

Founder & CEO · Dashbot

Conversational-AI Analytics · Acquired strategic positioning

2016 — 2022 · San Francisco

- Founded and led **Dashbot** — analytics & conversational-intelligence platform for chatbots, voice assistants, and conversational AI. De-facto standard for **bot analytics, voice analytics, NLU evaluation**.
- Scaled to **20,000+ customers** processing **90+ billion conversational messages** — Google, T-Mobile, large financial-services and retail brands.
- Raised **\$15.6M** from Bessemer Venture Partners, ff Venture Capital, a16z scout fund.
- Industry recognition: **Gartner Cool Vendor 2018, MIT AI Idol 2018, Voicebot Top 11 People in Voice**. Quoted in TechCrunch, VentureBeat, The Information, Voicebot.ai.
- Created & ran **Superbot**, the annual conversational-and-agentic-AI conference.

Founder · Motally (acquired by Nokia, 2010)

2008 — 2010 · San Francisco

- Founded one of the earliest **mobile-app analytics** platforms — instrumentation for native iOS, Android, BlackBerry, Symbian apps. **Acquired by Nokia** in 2010 to power Symbian / MeeGo developer analytics.

EDUCATION & SIDE PROJECTS

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) — Engineering & CS foundation. Active MIT alumni community in SF AI ecosystem. | **Reconify** — building observability & analytics for generative-AI applications (the Dashbot of the LLM era). | Active angel investor in conversational, agentic, voice, and developer-tools startups.

SPEAKING & RECOGNITION

Awards: Gartner Cool Vendor 2018 · MIT AI Idol 2018 · Voicebot Top 11 People in Voice. **Keynote / Panel:** SXSW · Mobile World Congress · MobileBeat · Voice Summit · World AI Cannes · Project Voice · AWS re:Invent · Microsoft Build · Web Summit · VOICE Global. **Press:** TechCrunch · VentureBeat · The Information · Voicebot.ai · Forrester · Gartner. **Writing:** *The Agentic Shift* (2026) — working thesis on the move from chatbots to AI employees.

CORE COMPETENCIES & STACK

AI / ML Domains: Agentic AI · autonomous agents · conversational AI · voice AI · LLMs · foundation models · multi-agent systems · tool use · function calling · MCP · RAG · reasoning models · inference-time compute.

Platforms: Amazon Bedrock · Azure AI Foundry · Azure OpenAI · OpenAI API · Anthropic Claude · Google Gemini · LangChain · LangGraph · LlamaIndex · Dialogflow · Lex · Rasa · Voiceflow.

GTM & Partnerships: Enterprise GenAI sales · ISV / partner ecosystem · co-sell · marketplace GTM · DevRel programs · analyst relations.

Founder Toolkit: Venture fundraising · board management · product strategy · executive hiring · M&A (Motally / Nokia) · category creation · keynote speaking.

Keywords: agentic AI, AI agents, autonomous agents, AI employees, multi-agent systems, conversational AI, voice AI, chatbot, bot analytics, voice analytics, LLM, large language model, foundation model, GPT, Claude, Gemini, Amazon Bedrock, Azure OpenAI, Azure AI Foundry, Copilot Studio, Microsoft, AWS, Anthropic, OpenAI, Google DeepMind, generative AI, GenAI, ML, NLU, NLP, RAG, tool use, function calling, MCP, Model Context Protocol, reasoning, planning, founder, CEO, two-time founder, exit, acquisition, Nokia, Dashbot, Motally, Reconify, Bessemer, ff VC, a16z, partnerships, BD, business development, marketplace, ecosystem, ISV, co-sell, GTM, enterprise AI, head of partnerships, head of generative AI, Gartner Cool Vendor, MIT AI Idol, Voicebot, Superbot, Built on Bedrock, SXSW, Voice Summit, Project Voice, World AI Cannes, MWC, Web Summit, keynote speaker, AI evangelist, AI thought leader, AI advisor, angel investor.